

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1974 RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING EDUCATION FOR INTERNATIONAL UNDERSTANDING, CO-OPERATION AND PEACE AND EDUCATION RELATING TO HUMAN RIGHTS AND FUNDAMENTAL FREEDOMS

I. Introduction

A. About the 1974 Recommendation

1. UNESCO's 1974 *Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms*¹ (the "1974 Recommendation") aims to promote international education and world peace through understanding, solidarity and cooperation. It was adopted on 19 November 1974 by the General Conference of UNESCO at its 18th session.

2. The 1974 *Recommendation* applies to formal, non-formal and informal education and to all levels, from pre-primary to tertiary and adult education and lifelong learning. The General Conference recommended "*that Member States should apply*" the provisions included in the 1974 *Recommendation* "*by taking whatever legislative or other steps*" that provide institutional (e.g. policies and legal frameworks) and pedagogical (e.g. curricula, teacher training, educational materials, equipment, and student assessment) support for its implementation, based on the "*objectives*", referred to in paragraph 4 of the 1974 *Recommendation*, "*regarded as major guiding principles of education policy*" including: an international dimension and a global perspective on education, cultural diversity, interdependence, communication, rights and responsibilities, international solidarity and cooperation, and problem solving.

3. Today, the principles of the 1974 *Recommendation* apply equally well to Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) and to Global Citizenship Education (GCED) and therefore represent a powerful tool for promoting the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and in particular SDG Target 4.7 on the promotion of sustainable development and global citizenship through education, Target 12.8 on access to information on sustainable development and Target 13.3 on climate change education.

4. The General Conference in its 39th session recommended the use of the 1974 *Recommendation* reporting process to support the implementation and monitoring of Target 4.7 of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (39 C/Resolution 79). The UNESCO Executive Board at its 209th session approved the use of the current guidelines for both the monitoring of the 1974 *Recommendation* and the collection of data needed for the following global SDG indicator for which UNESCO is custodian (209 EX/Decision 18.II):

4.7.1, 12.8.1 and 13.3.1: *The extent to which (i) global citizenship education and (ii) education for sustainable development are mainstreamed in (a) national education policies; (b) curricula; (c) teacher education and (d) student assessment.*

5. Questions marked with an asterisk (*) will be used in the calculation of the respective indicators (**Table 1**). As approved by the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on the SDG Indicators, the indicators will be calculated for primary and secondary education only.

Table 1 Questions used in the calculation of the global SDG indicator for Targets 4.7, 12.8 and 13.3

Policies	Curricula	Teacher education	Student assessment
A2, A4, A5, E1a	B2, B3, B4, E1b	C2, C3, C4, C5, E1c	D2, D3, E1d

¹ http://portal.unesco.org/en/ev.php-URL_ID=13088&URL_DO=DO_TOPIC&URL_SECTION=201.html

B. Reporting obligations

6. The General Conference, at its 18th session, when adopting the *1974 Recommendation* recommended “*that Member States submit [...] reports concerning the action taken by them in pursuance of this recommendation*”. Moreover, in accordance with Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization [...] reports [...] on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4.*”

7. Thus, **all UNESCO Member States are expected to report on the steps they have taken to implement the 1974 Recommendation** preferably by completing the following questionnaire. Such reporting takes place every four years.

II. Guidelines for completion of the questionnaire

8. This questionnaire and its accompanying guidelines are addressed to Ministers responsible for relations with UNESCO. The questionnaire is typically completed by Ministries of Education and other government authorities responsible for education. Responses should cover, as far as possible, education at all levels of government, including sub-national levels where applicable as well as education outside the government sector.

9. National respondents are encouraged to **consult widely** both within, across and beyond government, including with Ministries of Environment, with national human rights institutions, the education sector, civil society partners and others, as necessary, to gather the information needed to complete the questionnaire.

10. Responses to the seventh consultation should cover:

- (i) the time period 2017-2020;
- (ii) education at all levels of formal education from pre-primary to tertiary education as well as non-formal education;
- (iii) all levels of government that have responsibility for education within the country; and
- (iv) where possible, education outside the government sector.

11. To assist countries in responding to this questionnaire, UNESCO has developed the following set of global citizenship education and education for sustainable development themes. The list is based on a review of current common practices in many countries as well as a review of relevant literature. While the terms ESD and GCED may be used differently in some countries, the list of themes typically captures what are seen as key elements of Target 4.7. Please refer to the definitions of key terms in **Section III** before completing the questionnaire.

Global citizenship education and education for sustainable development

1. cultural diversity and tolerance
 - 1.1 international or intercultural understanding, solidarity and cooperation
 - 1.2 intercultural and interreligious dialogue
 - 1.3 local, national and/or global citizenship
2. gender equality education
 - 2.1 gender-based equal opportunities
 - 2.2 gender equality and justice
 - 2.3 gender roles, identity and stereotypes
3. human rights education
 - 3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status
 - 3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation
 - 3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)
4. peace and non-violence
 - 4.1 friendly relations among peoples and nations
 - 4.2 challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together, including others and preventing violent extremism
 - 4.3 preventing all forms of violence including bullying, verbal abuse and gender-based violence
5. climate change education
 - 5.1 mitigation
 - 5.2 adaptation
 - 5.3 impact reduction
 - 5.4 early warning
6. environmental sustainability
 - 6.1 caring for the planet, protecting nature
 - 6.2 environmental justice
 - 6.3 biodiversity, water
7. human survival and well-being
 - 7.1 environmental health as it pertains to human well-being, disaster risk reduction
 - 7.2 health of the planet for future generations
 - 7.3 sustainable cities and communities
8. sustainable consumption and production
 - 8.1 responsible and sustainable lifestyles
 - 8.2 green economy, green jobs
 - 8.3 sustainable energy

III. Definitions of key terms

Term	Definition
Themes of global citizenship and education for sustainable development	
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	<i>Education about and for diversity including language, ethnicity, race, religion as well as the development of tolerance, mutual respect and appreciation for cultural diversity. It includes intercultural and interreligious dialogue, understanding, solidarity and co-operation, and citizenship education.</i>
2. Gender equality education	<i>Education that addresses the wider issue of gender equality by promoting new attitudes and patterns of belief, transforming the way people think about traditional gender roles and helping to build long-term sustainable change. It examines how gender roles, activities, needs, opportunities, rights and entitlements affect men, women, girls and boys differently. It deals with the relationships between females and males, their access to and control of resources and the constraints they face relative to each other. It respects the rights of all learners – women, men, boys and girls – equally and gives equal access to learning opportunities, resources and protections. All learners benefit from and are treated in education equally without the limitations set by stereotypes, rigid gender roles and prejudices. It covers gender-based equal opportunities, gender equality and justice, and gender roles, identity and stereotypes.</i>
3. Human rights education	<i>Education that promotes universal respect for and observance of all human rights and fundamental freedoms and thus contributes, inter alia, to the prevention of human rights violations and abuses by providing persons with knowledge, skills and understanding and developing their attitudes and behaviours, to empower them to contribute to the building and promotion of a universal culture of human rights.</i> <i>It includes equality and non-discrimination, human rights values, dignity, justice, inclusion and participation and respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms.</i>
4. Peace and non-violence	<i>Education about peace and peace-building, mediation, conflict prevention and resolution, non-violence, reconciliation and living together peacefully. It includes advocating for friendly relations among peoples and nations, challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together and preventing violent extremism and other forms of violence including bullying.</i>
5. Climate change education	<i>Education to help people, in particular youth, understand, address, mitigate, and adapt to the impacts of climate change. It encourages changes in attitudes and behaviours needed to put the world on a more sustainable development path, and build a new generation of climate change-aware citizens.</i> <i>It covers various responses to climate change including mitigation, adaptation, impact reduction and early warning.</i>
6. Environmental sustainability	<i>Education about responsible interactions with the environment to avoid depletion or degradation and to promote environmental quality and health. It includes, caring for the planet and protecting nature, environmental justice, biodiversity and water.</i>
7. Human survival and well-being	<i>Education that promotes social well-being and harmony including in future generations due to healthy environmental systems. It includes health of the planet and environment related to human well-being, disaster risk reduction and sustainable cities and communities.</i>

8. Sustainable consumption and production	<i>Education on the use and production of resources, products and services that have a minimal adverse impact on the environment. It promotes resource and energy efficiency, sustainable infrastructure and green jobs. It includes responsible and sustainable lifestyles, the green economy and sustainable energy.</i>
Dimensions of learning	
Knowledge	<i>Factual information and understanding acquired through study and/or experience.</i>
Skills	<i>The ability to carry out a task well as a result of training, practice and innate aptitude. Skills may be physical, mental or both.</i>
Values	<i>Principles that form the foundation on which individuals conduct themselves and interact with others and with the environment around them.</i>
Attitudes and behaviours	<i>Ability to act on the basis of beliefs and knowledge acquired through study or experience.</i>
Levels of education	
Pre-primary	<i>Education designed to support children's early cognitive, physical, social and emotional development and introduce young children to organized instruction outside of the family context. Participants are usually aged from three years.</i>
Primary and secondary	<i>Education designed to:</i> <i>(i) provide students with fundamental skills in reading, writing and mathematics (i.e. literacy and numeracy) and establish a solid foundation for learning and understanding core areas of knowledge and personal development (primary education); and</i> <i>(ii) prepare students for further education at post-secondary and tertiary levels and for entry into the labour market (secondary education).</i> <i>It includes both general and vocational education.</i>
Tertiary	<i>Education designed to provide learning activities in specialised fields of education. It aims at learning at a high level of complexity and specialisation. It includes both what is commonly understood as academic education and advanced vocational or professional education.</i>
Types of education	
Adult education	<i>Education specifically targeted at individuals who are regarded as adults by their society to improve their technical or professional qualifications, further develop their abilities, enrich their knowledge with the purpose to complete a level of formal education, or to acquire, refresh or update their knowledge, skills and competencies in a particular field.</i>
Formal education	<i>Education that is institutionalized, intentional and planned through public organizations and recognized private bodies which – in their totality – constitute the formal education system of a country. Formal education programmes are recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities. Formal education consists mostly of initial education (e.g., pre-primary, primary, secondary and tertiary education).</i>
Non-formal education	<i>Education that is an addition, alternative and/or a complement to formal education within the process of the lifelong learning of individuals. It is often provided to guarantee the right of access to education for all. It caters to people of all ages but does not necessarily apply a continuous pathway-structure. It may be short in duration and/or low-intensity, and it is typically provided in the form of short courses, workshops or seminars. Non-formal education mostly leads to qualifications that are not</i>

	<i>recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities or to no qualifications at all. Non-formal education includes programmes on life skills including literacy and numeracy, work skills, and social or cultural development. Most types of adult education are also included.</i>
Vocational education	<i>Education that is designed for learners to acquire the knowledge, skills and competencies specific to a particular occupation or trade or class of occupations or trades. Vocational education may have work-based components (e.g. apprenticeships). Successful completion of such programmes leads to labour-market relevant vocational qualifications acknowledged as occupationally-oriented by the relevant national authorities and/or the labour market. Vocational education can be offered at secondary and post-secondary or tertiary levels of education.</i>

IV. Information about the respondent

Country:

Ireland

Organization:

Department of Education

Date of submission:

February 2021

V. Other contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire

Please indicate below the names of other organizations and contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire.

Government institutions including other Ministries (please specify):

National human rights institutions (please specify):

Local and regional authorities responsible for education (please specify):

Irish Development Education Association
6 Gardiner Row
Dublin 1

Other local and regional authorities (please specify):

Organizations representing education stakeholders (e.g. teachers, students, parents, etc.)
(please specify):

Other civil society organizations (please specify):

Others (please specify):

VI. Questionnaire

A1 Please describe any specific national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal framework(s) in your country that govern the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes² are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of Education are covered.

Irish society has incorporated many of the 1974 Recommendation, promoting gender equality, legislation to eradicate discrimination on grounds of ethnicity, sexual orientation, etc. **The Equal Status Act of 2000** is a central pillar in this reform agenda.

In specific educational legislation the **Educational Act 1998** An Act to make provisions in the interest of the common good for the education of Every Person in the State, including any person with disabilities or who has other special educational needs, and to provide generally for primary, post-primary, adult and continuing education and vocational education and training; to ensure that the education system is accountable to students, their parents and the State for the education provided, respects the diversity of values, beliefs, languages and traditions in Irish society and is conducted in the spirit of partnership between schools, patrons, students, parents, teachers and other school staff, the community served by the school and the State; to provide for the recognition and funding of schools and their management through boards of management; to provide for an inspectorate of schools, to provide for the role and responsibilities of principals and teachers; to establish the national council for curriculum and assessment and to make provisions for it, and to provide for related matters.

This has helped transform the transparency and partnerships in education, recognising the rights and obligations of school leaders and managers, parents and students and aligning education with the values of modern Ireland.

A1b Please provide the full names of any laws, legislation or legal framework referred to in A1 and were possible web links to relevant documents.

Equal Status Act 2000 [Equal Status Act](#)

Educational Act 1998 [Educational Act 1998](#)

The Education (Admission to Schools) Act 2018 [Education Admissions to Schools Act 2018](#)

The National Strategy on Education for Sustainable Development 2014-2020

An audit of the primary and post primary curricula for opportunities and linkages to ESD was published in 2018: https://ncca.ie/media/3573/esdreport_final_june2018.pdf

A **National Access Plan steering committee** is responsible for monitoring progress and provide advice on matters pertaining to the implementation of the National Access Plan for 2015-2021. Representatives on the steering group comprise of key stakeholders who are involved in promoting equity of access to higher education. These include Department representatives, the HEA, SOLAS, THEA, IUA, ETBI, USI, NCSE, AHEAD, PAVEE Point, AONTAS, Representatives of Access Officers, Disability Officers and Mature Students.

The Mitigating Educational Disadvantaged Working Group (MED) was one of a number of tertiary education groups established as a result of the Covid-19 pandemic. The MED group

was set up in recognition of the effects that the Covid-19 pandemic would have on vulnerable learners in the further and higher education sectors. The group is, therefore, ad hoc in nature.

National strategy on education for sustainable developmentThe Education (Admission to Schools) Act 2018 was signed into law on the 18th July 2018. The Act creates a more parent-friendly, equitable and consistent approach to how school admissions policies operate for all primary and post primary schools.

The National Strategy on Education for Sustainable Development 2014-2020 aims to contribute to the UN Sustainable Development Goals Target 4.7 to ensure that by 2030 “By 2030 *“all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation*”

***A2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal frameworks on education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.**

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	National				Sub-national			
	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1

A3 Please describe any specific current national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives in your country that promote global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes³ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

Sustainable development themes and principles are integrated across the Irish school curriculum at all levels specifically:

At Early Years (0-6years), Aistear is the curriculum framework in Ireland. It provides information for adults to help them plan for and provide enjoyable and challenging experiences so that all children can grow and develop as competent and confident learners within loving relationships with others. The curriculum explores and promotes the concept of citizenship and social justice with children and respects them as young citizens:

A new draft **Primary Curriculum Framework**, published by the National Council for Curriculum and Assessment for public consultation in February 2020, includes “Active Citizenship” as a key competency aimed at fostering within children the knowledge, skills, concepts, attitudes, values and dispositions that motivate and empower them as citizens to take positive actions to live justly, sustainably and with regard for the rights of others. It helps children question, critique and understand what is happening in the world within a framework of human rights, equality and social justice. It places democratic practices at the centre of the learning process. This competency develops children’s capacity and motivation for active and meaningful participation in society at local, national and global levels, and fosters their ability to contribute positively and compassionately towards the creation of a more sustainable and just world.

The Junior Cycle Framework (2015) includes 12 statements of learning which encompass valuing what it means to be an active citizen, with rights and responsibilities in local and wider contexts and the awareness, knowledge, skills, values and motivation to live sustainably.

Wellbeing has also been a key aspect of the Junior Cycle Framework. The Department of Education published a **Wellbeing Policy and Framework for practice (2018-2023)**, outlining a comprehensive, whole-school approach to the promotion of wellbeing and the academic, physical, mental, emotional, social and spiritual development of all children and young people. It focuses on the whole school community, as well as groups and individual young people with identified needs.

Senior cycle education aims to foster an understanding and appreciation of moral, spiritual, aesthetic, social and cultural values that have been distinctive in shaping Irish society. Through their educational experiences, students will learn to understand the values of their own communities, to express their own values, to develop empathy for the values of others, to critically analyse differences in values, and to make ethical decisions. They will also learn to acknowledge and reflect the values of a democratic society, respecting the diverse beliefs and ways of life of others. The principles of senior cycle education inform curriculum planning, development, provision and implementation in schools. They set out the important underpinnings for the curriculum as it is realised in schools. The principles are: Quality, Inclusive education, Continuity, Choice and flexibility, Participation, relevance and enjoyment, Well-being, Creativity and innovation, and Lifelong learning

Our main progress in these areas has come through the revised curriculum at ISCED 1 (since 1999), the Framework for Junior Cycle (2015) and its accompanying focus on student-centred learning, group work, innovation, etc.

We also have a formal Arts in Education charter (2013) with another government department, which has helped to foster a range of initiatives in this field.

Our revised Primary Languages curriculum aims at making language learning more cohesive in the early years of ISCED 1, which, fosters greater linguistic and intercultural understanding.

Implementation of the Erasmus+ Programme in the field of education in Ireland facilitates and supports school staff and students to develop a global education perspective and experience cultural diversity through eTwinning, project partnerships, exchanges and work placements involving schools/institutions from other Programme Countries.

The Department of Education has also cooperated with other government departments to promote and reinvigorate reform. For example, there is an overarching *Public Service Reform Plan 2014 to 2016*. We support the Department of Children, Equality, Disability, Integration and Youth *Better Outcomes Brighter Futures – the National Policy Framework for Children & Young People 2014-2020* and have been significantly influenced by the Department of Health's *Healthy Ireland: A Framework for Improved Health and Wellbeing 2013 to 2025*, an initiative which aims to improve the health and wellbeing of people living in Ireland. The department is represented on a number of groups including the National Physical Activity Plan Implementation Group and on the Obesity Policy Implementation Oversight Group. All of these initiatives, and more, have resonance with the 1974 Recommendation.

A fundamental tenet of the Irish higher education sector is the principle of academic freedom which is shared by all institutions. The sector fully subscribes to the principles outlined in the UNESCO recommendation in terms of ensuring that all individuals or groups are treated equally and that there should be no discrimination "based on sex, race, colour, ethnic or social origin, religion or belief, political or any other opinion, membership of a national minority, disability, age or sexual orientation".

The sector in its teaching and research provides a range of courses and research opportunities that expand our knowledge in the areas of human rights and fundamental freedoms. Such courses can be found in the areas of, inter alia, human rights, politics, law, environmental science, agriculture, medicine, sociology, education, communications, police studies and other related areas.

The Irish Centre for Human Rights is located at the National University of Ireland Galway. It is one of the world's premier university-based institutions for the study and promotion of human rights and humanitarian law. Since its establishment in 2000, the Centre has developed a global reputation for excellence in the field of human rights teaching, research and advocacy.

Endorsing the principle that all citizens have a fundamental right to access higher education, the National Office for Equity of Access to Higher Education (from 2014 the National Access Policy Office) was established in the Higher Education Authority in 2003 to facilitate educational access and opportunity for groups who are under-represented in higher education. The overall goal of access policy in higher education is that the student population in our higher educational institutions will reflect the diversity of Ireland's population at large.

The third National Plan for Equity of Access to Higher Education (2015 – 2021) was launched in December 2015. The vision of the National Access Plan is to ensure that the student body entering into, participating in and completing higher education at all levels reflects the diversity and social mix of Ireland's population.

The Plan identifies the target groups that are currently under-represented in higher education. These include entrants from socio-economic groups that have low participation in

higher education, Irish Travellers, students with disabilities, first time mature student entrants, part-time/flexible learners and further education award holders. Lone parents are also included in this grouping.

Consultations on the next National Access Plan will commence early 2021.

The Student Grant Scheme provides supports to qualifying full-time students in further and higher education. The move to a centralised system for the administration of student grants was part of a wider programme of administrative and legislative reform. These are underpinned by the Student Support Act 2011.

The means-test of the Student Grant Scheme is a fundamental element of the student grant administration process. It is the mechanism that identifies whose income is to be considered for grant assessment purposes. It is key to ensuring that the scheme is equitable and is targeted appropriately.

The student support scheme is the key policy intervention to support access to further and higher education. The term “access” is generally understood to comprehend entry into further and/or higher education, the retention of students within the system and their successful completion; so that the student can develop to his or her full potential.

The main aims of the scheme is to:

- Provide a contribution towards the cost of further or higher education in order to assist as many students as possible to obtain one qualification at each level of study (undergraduate and postgraduate). This enables individuals to develop their full potential through further and higher education and participate fully as members of society, which will contribute to Ireland's social, cultural and economic development.
- Target funds at those identified as “most in need” of assistance through terms and conditions of funding, including means-testing. The Student Grants Scheme, including means-testing arrangements, are kept under review to ensure that the available funding is targeted equitably and towards those who require assistance the most.
- Promote equality/equity of access to further and higher education in order to ensure participation rates reflect the general population/wider society. The provision of student grant supports assist in addressing the financial barriers to enter, participate in and successfully complete further and higher education, thereby ensuring that the student body at all levels reflects the diversity and social mix of Ireland's population.

Under the Erasmus+ programme, all participating Irish higher education institutions agree to subscribe to “respect in full the principles of non-discrimination set out in the Programme and ensure equal access and opportunities to mobile participants from all backgrounds.”

IDEA, the Irish Development Education Association, is the national network for Development Education in Ireland and a leading voice for the sector.

The Sustainable Development Goals and the Paris Agreement on Climate Change, both adopted in 2015, are having a strong influence on the work of the Development Education sector and will continue to do so in the coming years. The delivery of Development Education in Ireland is now a commitment under the SDGs, and in turn Development Education has a

crucial role to play in the realisation of these goals. The Development Education community will also play a crucial role in supporting the goals of the Paris Agreement by continuing to deliver education about the effects of climate change and to shift the discourse from climate change to climate justice. It will also be focusing on raising awareness of acute issues such as migration, while challenging the shift towards extremism by encouraging critical reflection.

The context for Development Education in Ireland has been affected by recent political, economic and policy-related developments both nationally and internationally. The refugee crisis, climate change and other worldwide challenges such as the economic crisis have brought global justice issues to the fore. Inequality, globally and within countries, has become more extreme. The rise of isolationism and threats posed to multi-literalisms reinforce the importance of education for global citizenship and sustainable development. New technologies are also changing the way we communicate and are reconfiguring our understanding of what is local, who our community is, and what is important in our lives. Development Education in Ireland has a wide reach, enabling the sector to engage with hundreds of thousands of people across all ages and communities throughout the island of Ireland each year. It is now more essential than ever as Irish society strives to understand and constructively react to local and global issues.

Development Education takes place across a wide range of formal, non-formal and informal⁴ settings, and involves learners of all ages. Development Education activities can take place within the remit of a structured project or can be delivered by individual teachers or leaders on an ad hoc basis. The sections that follow refer to some, but by no means all, of the projects taking place in Ireland, with an emphasis on the work of IDEA members

Please see Irish Development Association Educational Association (IDEA) Submission regarding UNESCO report on 1974 Recommendations and Development Education in Ireland Report

A3b

<https://www.ideaonline.ie/>

⁴ The boundaries between 'formal', 'non-formal' and 'informal' education can be fluid. For basic definitions see <http://www.oecd.org/edu/skills-beyondschool/recognitionofnon-formalandinformallearning-home.htm>.

***A4 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives affecting each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell**

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

***A5 Please indicate whether national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives on education provide a mandate to integrate GCED and ESD in the following areas by entering the appropriate number in each white cell**

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	1
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	1
Textbook development	1	1	1	1
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	1	1
Sub-national				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	1
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	1
Textbook development	1	1	1	1
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	1	1

Curriculum (paras 4 and 10-19 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

B1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in school curricula. Indicate whether topics are taught as standalone subjects or are integrated into the curricula of other subjects. Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes⁵ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

Curriculum reforms in recent years have included revisions at ISCED 2 to incorporate civic education within the 'wellbeing' area of learning (2015), including a wellbeing framework (2018-2023) which supports an integrated curriculum planning approach to the provision of courses on wellbeing, based on the belief that civic participation is a key part of a student's wellbeing, just as social and health education are. Work continues to revise the specifications for these curricular areas at this level. The introduction of Politics and Society at ISCED 3 gives a prominence and importance to civic, environmental and sociological education, and helps to link ISCED 3 to third level education opportunities much more strongly than before.

The Department of Education published its National Strategy on Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) 2014-2020 and an interim review of the strategy in 2018. It will develop a follow on strategy for ESD to 2030 during 2021 in consultation with key stakeholders, to align with the UN Sustainable Goals Target 4.7 and with UNESCOs Framework for ESD for 2030.

The Department has also published anti-bullying procedures for schools (2013), and strongly supports Children First (2011) our national child protection strategy. In addition, the Education (Student and Parent Charter) Bill, 2019 aims to improve how schools engage with students and their parents.

Important progress has been made in pre-school and early years education (ISCED 0/1), including the provision of education-focused inspections. All children can now avail of two free years of state-funded childcare, with implementation of an educational and developmental programme called Aistear. This is premised on the understanding that all children from birth are citizens with rights and responsibilities. *Aistear* emphasises the importance of children having opportunities to participate in making decisions about matters which affect them. This principle is foundational in the National Children's Strategy (2000).

Through cross and co-curricular delivery. At ISCED 1, a lot of work is done at a cross-curricular level, and even at ISCED 0 ('early years'), there is good provision for pupils' engagement with rights and basic citizenship issues through the Aistear Framework (see above).

At ISCED 2 and 3, school culture also fosters students' councils, student participation in decision making and a range of active citizenship possibilities. Our Transition Year for instance, the first year of ISCED 3 for most students, often sees a strong focus on community service, development education and social innovation.

At ISCED 1, Social, Environmental and Scientific Education (SESE) encompasses History, Geography and Science. SESE seeks to generate an appreciation of cultural and historical inheritance and cultivates an atmosphere of equality and opportunity where gender, cultural diversity, minorities and special needs are respected and valued. Prejudice and discrimination are challenged while respect and mutual understanding are promoted. The curriculum for

⁵.

Geography in SESE stresses that the subject 'fosters not only their sense of local identity but their sense of being members of national, European and global communities. It encourages them to appreciate the interdependence of individuals, groups, and communities, and it promotes an understanding of and a respect for the cultures and ways of life of peoples throughout the world. It fosters, too, an informed sense of individual and community responsibility for environmental care.' D1A

The Department also sees an important link between the promotion of human rights, tolerance, equality of opportunity and other aims of the 1974 Recommendation, and the pursuit of literacy and numeracy and other key skills. To that effect, we feel that our National Literacy and Numeracy Strategy (2011), and its Review (2017), along with our Digital Strategy for Schools (2015) are important steps in the battle against inequality and inequity. Development of follow on strategies will be progressed in 2021.

Politics, Society and Wellbeing, including CSPE and SPHE are covered under the curricula.

B1b. Please provide examples of curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents

Including the above mentioned, Irish Aid runs the 'Our World' programme, a national awards scheme for primary schools. The Our World programme was established to raise awareness among Irish primary pupils of the UN Millennium Development Goals.

The An Taisce Environmental Education Unit, in partnership with Local Authorities throughout the country, operates the 'Green-Schools' international environmental education programme. In Ireland (more than 90% of all Irish schools) are currently participating in the programme and over 3,100 schools have been awarded the Green Flag, making the Irish Green-Schools programme one of the most successful within the international network. Three of the eight themes within the Green-School programme are linked to 'Global Citizenship'.

The Irish National Teachers Organisation (INTO) runs a Global Citizenship School programme, which supports primary schools to learn about and act on global issues. The programme provides lesson plans, resources, and suggestions for possible actions to take as follow-ons from learning about global rights and responsibilities.

A number of International Development NGOs run programmes for the primary classroom. Trócaire runs a 'Better World' Awards programme for primary pupils, recognising creative responses to their annual Development Education Lenten Resource, which in 2017 focused on climate change. The popular Concern Debates programme for post-primary school has been extended into the upper classes at primary level, encouraging pupils to develop public speaking, research and language, skills and to gain a deeper understanding of Global issues affecting millions of people.

GOAL, Plan International Ireland, and ChildFund Ireland, provide classroom visits and/or curriculum-linked resource material. Inputs may be linked to specific countries where the organisations work, or they may relate to a development specialism (such as gender equality or child health) of the organisation.

The Centre for Human Rights and Citizenship Education (CHRCE) at the DCU Institute of Education and Trócaire have been working in partnership to provide Development Education supports for Early Years and Primary teachers. 'Just Children', an initiative aimed at Early Years Educators, has provided creative storybased activity plans enabling children between the ages of three and six to explore issues of fairness and similarities/differences in a global

context. CHRCE and Trócaire also have a partnership in Global Schools: Primary Education for a Just World, launched in 2015. This project aims to embed global learning and Development Education into primary education across Europe, through Continuing Professional Development (CPD) for teachers, awareness raising, resource development and research. The Global Schools project focuses on the themes of migration and climate change.

Amnesty International Ireland offers curriculum-linked Human Rights Education classroom resources, available for use from Junior Infants through to Sixth Class, with each resource building on the knowledge and skills acquired in the previous set of lessons.

The official programme of support for Development Education at post-primary level is WorldWide Global Schools (WWGS), funded through a strategic partnership with Irish Aid and implemented by a consortium consisting of Gorta Self Help Africa, Concern Worldwide and the City of Dublin ETB Curriculum Development Unit. The aim of WWGS is to increase the number of schools engaging with Development Education nationwide, as well as the quality of that engagement. WWGS seeks to foster a shared and consistent understanding of Development Education theory and practice at post-primary level, based on knowledge, skills, values, attitudes and active teaching and learning methodologies.

***B2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.**

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	0	1	1	1
5. Climate change	0	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	0	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	0	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	0	1	1	1

***B3 Please indicate in which subjects or fields of study GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.**

	Cultural diversity and tolerance	Gender equality	Human rights	Peace and non-violence	Climate change	Environmental sustainability	Human survival and well-being	Sustainable consumption and production
Arts	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
Civics, civil or citizenship education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Ethics/moral studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Geography	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Health, physical education and sports	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
History	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Languages	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Mathematics	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
Religious education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Science	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Social studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Integrated studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1

***B4 Please indicate the approaches used to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell**

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	1 (Politics, Society and Wellbeing, including CSPE and SPHE)
Cross-curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1 (Yes)
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1 (Yes)
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1 (Yes)

B5 Please indicate which human rights education themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
3. Human rights education	1	1	1	1
3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status	1	1	1	1
3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation	1	1	1	1
3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)	1	1	1	1

C Teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) (paras 4 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

Initial Teacher Education at Primary Level:

The DICE (Development and Intercultural Education) Project is a national education initiative, funded through a Strategic Partnership with Irish Aid, which promotes and supports the integration of Development Education and Intercultural Education in Initial Teacher Education at primary level in Ireland. The Project is implemented by four higher education institutions and works to support teacher educators and student teachers within these institutions, to integrate global and intercultural perspectives and themes into their teaching practice and wider university/school environments., DICE seeks to promote global solidarity, human rights and environmental awareness, and to support people to recognise and challenge discrimination and inequality, globally and locally.

C1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in initial training and in continuing professional development of teachers, trainers and educators. Indicate whether all teachers, trainers and educators or only some are required to receive training to teach GCED and/or ESD.

A number of courses relevant to the 1974 UNESCO Recommendation are provided in adult and further education, but at the discretion of individual providers rather than as a State provision. The State now offers two free years of pre-school provision for all children, and has increased its expectations in this sector in terms of teacher qualifications, delivery of literacy and numeracy and the Aistear Framework.

Teacher training at both primary and secondary levels focuses on content e.g. Social, Personal and Health Education but also on methodologies which promote rights, teamwork,

taking individual responsibility for one's own learning and behaviour, counteracting bullying, understanding and encouraging diversity and tolerance

DICE has been successful in embedding Development Education and Intercultural Education within the Bachelor of Education and Professional Master of Education programmes at primary level, including through mandatory and elective modules and integrated learning. While the terminology used and themes taught across partner institutions vary, with specific materials and approaches linked to the lecturer's expertise and institutional priority areas, all programmes are underpinned by a common set of values and concepts. A range of global and intercultural themes are explored within modules and lecturers are mindful of the need to: deepen knowledge of the relevant themes; explore and reflect on students' perspectives and those of others; and model the introduction of topics using participatory methodologies, applicable to the primary school classroom.

C1b. Please provide examples of teacher training policies or curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents. If possible, include examples related to initial training and to continuing professional development.

A Taskforce on Active Citizenship report (2007) was an important stimulus to recent work relevant to the UNESCO 1974 Recommendation. More specifically, the Department of Education has engaged with our National Council for Curriculum and Assessment (NCCA) and education stakeholders in curricular projects. It supports the work of agencies such as, Junior Cycle for Teachers, the Professional Development Service for Teachers, The National Council for Special Education and the Teaching Council – all of these have respective roles in developing resources, training and recognising the qualifications of teachers.

The work includes a focus on children's rights and human rights, teaching post-conflict and controversial issues. A number of initiatives have identified improving North-South understanding on our own island as a priority, under Education for Reconciliation and various 'Peace' programmes. The Department has also taken a lead role in developing the national ESD strategy, the Digital Strategy for Schools and the National Literacy and Numeracy Strategy. We also participate in international projects and surveys which promote the aims of the 1974 Recommendation e.g. 2011 ICCS report, ET2020 working group, the Working Group on the Implementation of the Council Declaration on the Fight against Anti-Semitism,, membership of the International Holocaust Remembrance Alliance.

The Department also sees an important link between the promotion of human rights, tolerance, equality of opportunity and other aims of the 1974 Recommendation, and the pursuit of literacy and numeracy and other key skills. To that effect, we feel that our National Literacy and Numeracy Strategy (2011), and its Review (2017), along with our Digital Strategy for Schools (2015) are important steps in the battle against inequality and inequity. Development of follow on strategies will be progressed in 2021.

There has been an increased emphasis on inclusion throughout the FET System. Fostering Inclusion is one of the three core pillars around which the Further Education and Training Strategy (FET) 2020-2024 is built and is embedded in the strategy along with the additional pillars of building skills and creating pathways. The FET sector is committed to increasing levels of inclusion through the provision of high quality, more accessible and flexible education and training programmes and supports suited to the identified needs of individuals, and proactively addressing systemic and structural barriers within FET to learner participation and success, with the aim of enabling every citizen to participate fully in society.

***C2 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach GCED and ESD during initial or pre-service training and/or through continuing professional development. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.**

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Initial or pre-service training	1	1	1	1
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	9	9	9	9
Continuing professional development	1	1	1	1
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	1	1	1	1

***C3 Please indicate on which GCED and ESD themes pre-service or in-service training is available for teachers, trainers and educators at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.**

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

***C4 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach the following dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.**

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	1	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	1

***C5 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to use the following approaches to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.**

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	1 (Politics and Society and Wellbeing, including CSPE and SPHE)
Cross curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1 (Yes)
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1 (Yes)
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment, and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1 (Yes)

D. Student assessment (paras 4 and 5 of the 1974 Recommendation)

D1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are covered in student assessments and examinations. Indicate whether students are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours.

At ISCED 1, Social, Environmental and Scientific Education (SESE) encompasses History, Geography and Science. SESE seeks to generate an appreciation of cultural and historical inheritance and cultivates an atmosphere of equality and opportunity where gender, cultural diversity, minorities and special needs are respected and valued. Prejudice and discrimination are challenged while respect and mutual understanding are promoted. The curriculum for Geography in SESE stresses that the subject 'fosters not only their sense of local identity but their sense of being members of national, European and global communities. It encourages them to appreciate the interdependence of individuals, groups, and communities, and it promotes an understanding of and a respect for the cultures and ways of life of peoples throughout the world. It fosters, too, an informed sense of individual and community responsibility for environmental care.

The revised Junior Cycle Framework places an increasing the emphasis on skills, competencies, values and behaviours, as well as increasing the role of formative assessment as a means of promoting and deepening student learning. Current revisions to specification in wellbeing subjects set out that assessment of the wellbeing subjects at ISCED 2 will be done through classroom based assessments and not at state examination level.

***D2 Please indicate whether the GCED and ESD themes below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.**

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	9	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	9	1	1	1
5. Climate change	9	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	9	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	9	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	9	1	1	1

***D3 Please indicate which of the dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.**

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	9
Skills	1	1	1	9
Values	1	1	1	9
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	9

E. Mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment (paras 4-5, 7, 10-19 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

***E1** Based on your responses to questions in the previous four sections (laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment) please indicate to what extent global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD) are mainstreamed⁶ in (a) education laws and policies, (b) curricula (c) teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) and (d) student assessment in your country. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell in the table below.

KEY:

0 Not at all GCED and ESD are not mainstreamed.

1 Partially Some GCED and/or ESD themes⁷ are mainstreamed. Select this option if GCED is mainstreamed but ESD is not (or vice versa).

2 Extensively Most GCED and ESD themes are mainstreamed.

9 Not known It is not known whether GCED and ESD are mainstreamed or not.

99 Not applicable The given level of government does not have responsibility for the given component (policies, curricula, teacher education or student assessment) and/or does not have responsibility for the given level or type of education. This may occur at the national level in federal countries where education is the responsibility of individual states or at the sub-national level in small countries where there is only one level of government.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
(a) Education laws and policies	1	1	1	1
(b) Curricula	9	1	1	1
(c) Teacher education	1	1	1	1
(d) Student assessment	9	1	1	1
Sub-national				
(a) Education laws and policies	1	1	1	1
(b) Curricula	1	1	1	1
(c) Teacher education	1	1	1	1
(d) Student assessment	1	1	1	9

⁶ GCED and ESD are mainstreamed if their themes are mentioned explicitly in relevant documents and are expected to be implemented by the relevant authorities (e.g. Ministries, regional or local education authorities), educational institutions (e.g. schools, colleges and universities) and/or education professionals (e.g. teachers, lecturers, trainers and educators) as appropriate.

⁷ Refer to the schema in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

F. Technical and vocational education and training (paras 25-29 of the 1974 *Recommendation*)

- F1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

A number of courses relevant to the 1974 UNESCO Recommendation are provided in adult and further education, but at the discretion of individual providers rather than as a State provision.

Resources include those developed by the department's agencies and support services such as, NCCA, JCT, NCSE and PDST as well as those provided by NGOs and various national initiatives which focus on human rights etc.

Note: the Department of Education does not produce or revise textbooks in Ireland. These are produced by commercial companies, but are guided by the Department's specifications and syllabi. Schools can determine which text books to use, if any, to best support their delivery of the curriculum in their own context.

G. Adult education (para 30 of the 1974 *Recommendation*)

- G1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in adult education and other forms of non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education, etc. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

SOLAS, the Further Education and Training Authority of Ireland, Education and Training Boards Ireland (ETBI), and the 16 Education and Training Boards (ETBs) across the country have progressed a series of actions to support the goal of Fostering Inclusion through the development and roll-out of a series of good practice guidelines to promote inclusion throughout FET. This includes the development of a conceptual framework for Universal Design for Learning (UDL) for the FET Sector. This approach aims to reduce obstacles to learning by taking into account the needs of learners of diverse backgrounds and abilities. Once in place, this will help all learners in FET, whatever their particular needs, and will make FET as widely accessible as possible.

The Further Education and Training (FET) system seeks to support the inclusion of *all* individuals, particularly marginalised individuals or communities, to participate in further education and training, and to enable every individual to fully participate in society. It strives to ensure that systemic and structural barriers within FET to learner participation and success are proactively addressed so that each learner can access the available learning opportunities and be enabled to fulfil his/her potential within FET.

As part of the annual FET service planning process that takes place between SOLAS and the Education and Training Boards (ETBs), ETBs are required to consider the needs of a broad range of learners and marginalised groups; these groups include but are not limited to women, migrants, members of the Traveller and Roma Communities, members of the LGBTQ+ Community, asylum seekers, people with disabilities, people from lower socio-economic groups. And through their quality assurance agreements with Quality and Qualifications Ireland (QQI) ETBs promote inclusive learning environments.

H. Research and International Co-operation (paras 41-45 of the 1974 Recommendation)

H1 Please describe what kinds of research or experimentation have been carried out to improve the implementation of GCED and/or ESD. Describe briefly how the results of such activities have influenced education policies, curricula and/or teaching practices

There is no data that can be drawn upon to give statistical evidence of these. In most schools, the co-curricular and extra-curricular programmes contain aspects of the principles and topics mentioned earlier and the system uses a range of media to promote good practice and values (wellbeing, adult literacy, counteracting bullying and anti-social behaviour).

Ireland is making substantial and consistent progress in promoting the 1974 Recommendation through education. In recent times the emphasis has focused on curricular reform and on the modernisation of pedagogy to create an optimum learning environment for students, where speaking and listening to each other, appreciating different views and cultures and a deepening understanding of rights and responsibilities is standard.

H2 Please indicate which types of activities are available that promote international co-operation at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Hosting of international meetings on GCED and/or ESD	0	9	1	1
Participation in international meetings abroad on GCED and/or ESD	9	1	1	1
Support for programmes hosting foreign students, researchers and/or teachers	9	1	1	1
Membership of international networks including ASPnet	9	9	1	1
Joint research projects on GCED and/or ESD with foreign institutions	9	9	1	1
Other activities (please specify):	9	1	1	1

Any other comments

I1 Please indicate whether your country has faced any constraints, in particular related to global or national crises, including natural disasters, in implementing the 1974 Recommendation during the reporting period

Due to a number of operational difficulties, the European Studies Programme which had fostered a number of the practices above at ISCED 2 and 3, has been discontinued. However, our post-primary schools continue to encourage student exchanges, links with schools abroad (supporting language learning and greater understanding). Increased broadband across the country delivered under the National Broadband plan will augment such opportunities further in even small rural schools

12 Please provide any other relevant information or clarifications regarding the implementation of the 1974 Recommendation or the mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in your country's education system.

The years 2012-2022 form a decade of centenaries and mark a very important decade in Irish history. It has seen a vast range of commemorative events and activities, but the decade has also had a very substantial focus on reflection and reimagining. By this, we mean using the springboard of historical understanding to encourage new thinking in our society – e.g. promote North-South understanding, social justice, equal rights, embracing the new multicultural Ireland and so on. At the time that the 1974 Recommendation was drawn up, these ideas were little more than aspirations. Today, they have a very concrete basis in Ireland and the decade of centenaries programme has done a huge amount to reinforce the vision.

All of this educational and commemorative work has a significant equality/human rights agenda, and has been done in partnership with a wide range of service providers and through open, public consultations. Many of our tertiary institutions offer courses in sociology, human rights, development education etc. and have a lot of on-campus groups and societies engaged in social work and reform, including support to developing countries.

Increased literacy and numeracy support is a key component of the new FET Strategy 2020-2024's strategic priority of Fostering Inclusion. Reflecting this and in line with the Programme for Government, SOLAS were tasked with the development of a new 10 year strategy for adult literacy, numeracy and digital literacy within six months.

The strategy will take a whole-of-government approach and provide a framework to support individuals to improve their literacy, numeracy and digital literacy, with the aim of ensuring that everyone has the literacy, numeracy and digital skills they require to meet their needs and to participate fully in society. Its development will involve input by relevant Government Departments and agencies and in consultation with key stakeholders. An interdepartmental stakeholder group on adult literacy, numeracy and digital literacy, which includes representatives from key Government Departments, relevant agencies and broader stakeholder organisations, has been established, and is chaired, by the Minister of Further and Higher Education, Research Innovation and Science. The role of the Interdepartmental Stakeholder Group is to advise, support and guide SOLAS throughout the development process. This group met for the first time on October 15th 2020 and it is envisaged that it will meet a further three times at key stages over the course of the strategy's development.

The Wellbeing Policy Statement and Framework for Practice sets out the Department's ambition and vision for wellbeing promotion, building on the many guidelines and frameworks that are already available to support and promote the wellbeing of children and young people. This document has been informed by extensive consultation with stakeholders and international research and practice.

Implementation of the Erasmus+ Programme in the field of education in Ireland facilitates and supports school staff and students to develop a global education perspective and experience cultural diversity through eTwinning, project partnerships, exchanges and work placements involving schools/institutions from other Programme Countries.

Languages Connect, Ireland's Strategy for Foreign Languages in Education 2017–2020 aims to increase awareness about the importance of foreign language learning both for economic and social reasons. Under this strategy, four new foreign languages were introduced to the curriculum at Leaving Certificate level in September 2019 (Mandarin

Chinese, Portuguese, Polish and Lithuanian). We also continue to increase the number of Foreign Language Assistants provided to schools to assist students, enrolled in participating schools, to see a foreign language as a living language and not just a “school language”.

In 2019 there was an audit undertaken on the place of Traveller history and culture in the curriculum, from ISCED 0 to 3 in order to identify current opportunities for children and young people to encounter and learn about aspects of Traveller culture and history. In addition, the audit aimed to identify future possibilities in this regard as curricula are reviewed and developed on a broader scale and in a wider context. The audit report has been completed and further actions based off the recommendations are being reviewed and undertaken.

More and more schools are involving students in decisions that directly affect them – uniforms, subject choice, policies such as anti-bullying and health education. At Tertiary level, the involvement of students in school governance, up to board of management level, is quite possible.

It is a policy of the Department of Education to include the student voice in consultation relating to the development of curriculum or strategies.

In addition, in 2020 students were part of the stakeholder consultations in relation to the adaption of the state examinations due to Covid 19, and they will be part of this process again in 2021.